Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 14 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Overcast	Drizzle
19° 11°	17° 10°	17° 9°	17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The head of English football's independent regulator says he will resign if he encounters any political interference over Manchester City's future.**

This follows reports that the majority of English football clubs are on the brink of financial disaster, making the regulator's role critical. The future of Man City, found guilty of breaching financial rules, is a major talking point.

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **The MI5 chief has warned against overstating Russian interference in the 2016 Brexit vote, after claims from Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham.**

This statement comes amid ongoing discussions about foreign influence in UK politics and elections. It highlights the intelligence community's nuanced view on the extent of such interference.

POLITICS · UK

3 **The Supreme Court is currently hearing an appeal in the church warden murder case, considering who legally caused Peter Farquhar's death.**

This high-profile case has gripped the nation, focusing on the legal complexities of responsibility and causation in a shocking murder. The outcome will set an important legal precedent.

CRIME · UK

4 **A new report reveals that the majority of English football clubs are in a precarious financial state, 'living on the edge of disaster'.**

This stark warning from an independent report highlights deep-seated financial issues across the sport. It raises serious questions about the sustainability of many clubs and the need for urgent reform.

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Clinicians are urging schools to cut screen time in classrooms, warning it's leading to a rise in long-term health issues like short-sightedness.**

This advice comes as technology use in education continues to grow, prompting concerns about its impact on children's health. It sparks a debate about the balance between digital learning and well-being.

HEALTH · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Raye has hit back at ticket touts after an incredible 1.8 million people tried to sign up for her 5,000-seat Royal Albert Hall show.**

The award-winning singer's popularity is soaring, but this huge demand has led to frustration for genuine fans. It highlights the ongoing battle artists face against secondary ticketing markets.

ON AIR — Have you ever missed out on tickets to a favourite artist because of touts?

MUSIC · NOW

2 **Rob Brydon and other 'Gavin and Stacey' stars are set to feature in a festive Julia Donaldson TV adaptation this Christmas.**

Fans of the beloved comedy will be delighted to hear some familiar voices bringing a popular children's book to life. It promises to be a charming addition to the holiday viewing schedule.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Julia Donaldson book, and which one would you love to see adapted next?

TV · CHRISTMAS

3 **Robert Pattinson stars in a new film, 'Primetime', exploring how hunting predators became hit TV.**

The actor takes on the role of the real-life host of the American show 'To Catch a Predator'. It's a fascinating look at the ethical complexities of true-crime entertainment.

ON AIR — Does the idea of a show like 'To Catch a Predator' make you feel uneasy or do you think it serves an important purpose?

FILM · UPCOMING

4 **A post-war sculpture by Barbara Hepworth, inspired by the Cornish landscape, could fetch up to £8 million at auction.**

This significant piece of British art history is expected to attract considerable international interest. It's a testament to Hepworth's enduring legacy and the value of modern sculpture.

ON AIR — If you could own any piece of art, what would it be and why?

ART · UPCOMING

5 **Fortnite-maker Epic Games has confirmed a 'huge pivot' towards using Artificial Intelligence in their future developments.**

The company's boss addressed critics, stating that the industry needs to embrace the future of technology. This move could significantly change how games are developed and experienced.

ON AIR — How do you feel about AI playing a bigger role in the games you play or the entertainment you consume?

GAMING · FUTURE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Rwanda has been chosen to host a Formula 1 Grand Prix, a 'landmark' moment for the sport in Africa.**

This historic deal means F1 will finally return to the African continent, succeeding where other nations have tried and failed. It's a huge step for the global expansion of motorsport.

ON AIR — Are you excited to see F1 race in Rwanda, and which other new destinations would you like to see on the calendar?

F1 · GLOBAL

2 **Liverpool's £116m signing Florian Wirtz is still struggling to hit top form, sparking debate about whether he needs to be dropped.**

More than a year after his big-money move, the pressure is mounting on the young midfielder. Fans and pundits are questioning if a spell out of the starting XI could help him rediscover his best.

ON AIR — If you were Jürgen Klopp, would you drop Florian Wirtz to give him a break, or keep him in to play through it?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Out-of-favour Tottenham striker Richarlison scored for the club's Under-21s in their EFL Trophy penalty shootout defeat.**

The Brazilian forward is clearly looking for game time and to regain his scoring touch. This appearance shows he's still working hard, even if it's not with the first team.

ON AIR — Do you think Richarlison can still turn his Spurs career around, or is it time for him to move on?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Jacob Bethell returns for England's white-ball tour of Australia, alongside first international call-ups for young prospects Thomas Rew and Eddie Jack.**

It's an exciting time for English cricket, with an experienced player returning and fresh talent being given a chance on the international stage. This tour will be a great test for the new faces.

ON AIR — Which young player are you most excited to see make their mark for England in Australia?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Wales and Ospreys scrum-half Kieran Hardy faces months out after needing surgery on an injured knee.**

This is a significant blow for both club and country, with Hardy being a key player. It's a tough recovery road ahead for the talented number nine.

ON AIR — How big a loss is Kieran Hardy for Wales and the Ospreys, and who do you think will step up in his absence?

RUGBY · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The simple joy of finding a perfectly smooth pebble is creating a new wave of 'pocket treasure' collectors.**
Many are rediscovering the delight of a quiet stroll along a beach or riverbank, specifically searching for small, naturally polished stones that fit just right in the palm of your hand. It's a lovely, tactile reminder of nature's artistry.

2 **A recent trend sees people sharing their 'most unusual tea-making rituals' on social media.**
From specific mug warm-up techniques to precise stirring patterns, it seems many of us have a quirky little routine for brewing that perfect cuppa. It highlights our deep affection for a good brew!

3 **The calming pastime of 'urban birdwatching' is gaining popularity, even in bustling cities.**
Residents are finding peace and connection with nature by simply observing the common sparrows, pigeons, and magpies that share our urban spaces. It's a reminder of the wildlife living right on our doorsteps.

4 **More households are embracing 'theme nights' for their evening meals, bringing a bit of fun to the dinner table.**
From 'Taco Tuesdays' to 'Pasta Fridays,' these planned culinary themes offer a lovely way to break up the week and encourage family participation in cooking. It adds a dash of joy to the everyday.

5 **The satisfying crackle of an open fire, even a digital one, is being sought out for its comforting qualities.**
As evenings draw in, many are turning to apps and streaming services that simply show a crackling fireplace, finding its ambient sound and visuals surprisingly soothing. It’s a modern take on a timeless comfort.

6 **A renewed appreciation for 'vintage board games' is seeing families dust off classics like Ludo and Snakes and Ladders.**
Away from screens, these nostalgic games are bringing generations together for some good old-fashioned fun and friendly competition. It's a lovely way to spend quality time.

7 **The humble 'doorstop' is getting a creative makeover, with many opting for quirky and characterful designs.**
No longer just a functional item, these charming doorstops, from little animals to miniature houses, are adding a touch of personality to our homes. It's a small detail that can bring a smile.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a new jar of jam, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ANSWER: 'GIVING IT A GOOD, SATISFYING TAP ON THE LID, JUST TO MAKE SURE IT'S PROPERLY SEALED!'

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: ANSWER: 'GIVING IT A QUICK SNIFF, RIGHT FROM THE BOTTLE, TO SEE IF IT SMELLS 'CLEAN' OR 'LUSH'!'

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular type of biscuit' that, no matter what, we just can't resist buying when we see it in the shop, don't we?**
  Perhaps it's a classic custard cream, a fancy shortbread, or a chocolate digestive – what's your go-to biscuit indulgence that always finds its way into your basket?

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday item' just instantly makes you feel a bit nostalgic or takes you back to a specific time?**
  Maybe it's the smell of a certain washing powder, the sound of a specific type of kettle boiling, or even an old-fashioned street lamp – what everyday item holds a surprisingly strong nostalgic pull for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Hummingbirds are the only birds that can fly backwards; however, they can't walk, so they hop everywhere.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£41 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£41 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- Ketchup was once sold as medicine in the 1830s.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- The world's oldest known living tree is over 5,000 years old and is a Bristlecone Pine in California.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 14 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 287 of the year, 78 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Angadrisma; Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Todi; Christian feast day: Joseph Schereschewsky (Episcopal Church (USA)); Christian feast day: Pope Callixtus I. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Cliff Richard, Indian-English singer-songwriter and actor
- 1990 — Jordan Clark, English cricketer
- 1963 — Lori Petty, American actress
- 1960 — Steve Cram, English runner and coach
- 1930 — Robert Parker, American singer and saxophonist (died 2020)
- 1962 — Trevor Goddard, English-American actor (died 2003)
- 1985 — Alanna Nihell, Irish boxer
- 1948 — Marcia Barrett, Jamaican-English singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1968 — Apollo program: The first live television broadcast by American astronauts in orbit is performed by the Apollo 7 crew.
- 2017 — An Al-Shabaab suicide bomber detonated a massive truck bomb at the Zobe junction in Somalia's capital, Mogadishu, killing 587 people, injuring 316 others, and leaving more than 500 missing.
- 1991 — Burmese opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi is awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1994 — Yasser Arafat, Yitzhak Rabin and Shimon Peres receive the Nobel Peace Prize for their role in the establishment of the Oslo Accords and the framing of future Palestinian self government.
- 1968 — Jim Hines becomes the first man ever to break the so-called "ten-second barrier" in the 100-meter sprint with a time of 9.95 seconds.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1991 — Burmese opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi is awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.
- 1966 — The city of Montreal begins the operation of its underground Montreal Metro rapid transit system.

- 2004 — MK Airlines Flight 1602 crashes during takeoff from Halifax Stanfield International Airport, killing all seven people on board.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 15 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 288 of the year, 77 days left in 2026. Today Breast Health Day (Europe); Christian feast day: Gundisalvus of Lagos; Christian feast day: Magdalene of Nagasaki; Christian feast day: Teresa of Ávila. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- **1984 — Jessie Ware, English singer-songwriter**
- **1968 — Vanessa Marcil, American actress**
- **1955 — Emma Chichester Clark, English author and illustrator**
- **1999 — Bailee Madison, American-Canadian actress and singer**
- **1957 — Mira Nair, Indian-American actress, director, and producer**
- **1958 — Stephen Clarke, English-French journalist and author**
- **1975 — Chukwudi Iwuji, Nigerian-British actor**
- **1955 — Tanya Roberts, American actress (died 2021)**

THE DAY TOMORROW

- **1979 — A coup d'état in El Salvador overthrows President Carlos Humberto Romero and begins the 12 year-long Salvadoran Civil War.**
- **2006 — The 6.7 Mw Kiholo Bay earthquake rocks Hawaii, causing property damage, injuries, landslides, power outages, and the closure of Honolulu International Airport.**
- **1944 — World War II: Germany replaces the Hungarian government after Hungary announces an armistice with the Soviet Union.**

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- **1951 — Mexican chemist Luis E. Miramontes completes the synthesis of norethisterone, the basis of an early oral contraceptive.**
- **1966 — The Black Panther Party is created by Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale.**

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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